

PUPIL NAME: _____

CLASS: _____

THE GREAT WAR: 1914–1919

Voluntary Enlistment, Trench Warfare, Global Empire & The Peace of Versailles

OVERARCHING HISTORICAL ENQUIRY:

“How did a single spark in Sarajevo ignite a global conflict that transformed the modern world?”



The Stubbington War Memorial Shelter on the Village Green, erected in 1922 to commemorate the 67 local men who died in the Great War.

Term: Autumn Term • Year **Edition:** 2026.1 Departmental Standard

Format: 20-Page Double-Page Spread (5 A3 Sheets)

GENRE 1

Causal Weighting

GENRE 2

Military Evaluation

GENRE 3

Local & Imperial Case

GENRE 4

Synoptic Synthesis

This workbook is a permanent academic record of historical scholarship. Bring it to every history lesson.

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

Target Level: _____

CRITERIA	Emerging (1–2): Recalls isolated facts; basic descriptive narrative of battles/trenches.	Emerging+ (3): Identifies causes & consequences with simple explanation.	Expected (4–5): Structured PEEL arguments; supports claims with specific wartime evidence.	Greater Depth (6–9): Analytical balance; nuanced historical judgements on total war.
EFFORT	1 • Concern: Disengaged / incomplete work.	2 • Inconsistent: Requires repeated prompting.	3 • Satisfactory: Meets baseline expectations.	4 • Good / 5 • Exemplary: Proactive focus; voluntary Scholar's Edge extension.

LESSON / ENQUIRY TITLE	EFFORT (1–5)	LEVEL	TEACHER FORMATIVE FEEDBACK & NEXT STEPS
LESSON 1 Why did so many young British men volunteer to join the armed forces in 1914?			
LESSON 2 Did British generals make the horror of trench warfare worse?			
LESSON 3 Why were the military contributions of 4 million colonial soldiers and labourers marginalized in British memory?			
LESSON 4 How far did the First World War transform the role of the British state and daily life on the Home Front?			
LESSON 5 Was the Treaty of Versailles a justified peace or a fatally flawed compromise?			
LESSON 6 How did the human cost of the Great War shatter and reshape our local Hampshire community of Stubbington?			
LESSON 7 "The First World War was a total war that completely transformed the modern world." How far do you agree? (1914–1919)			
FINAL UNIT LEVEL • TARGET OUTCOME:			

CURRICULUM ROADMAP & CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE

1914 – 1919

Trace the 5-year transformation of global conflict: from voluntary recruitment in 1914 to the bloodbath of the Somme, total home front mobilisation, and the Paris Peace Conference.

1914 **Outbreak, BEF Mobilisation & Kitchener's Call**
Assassination in Sarajevo; Britain enters war; 500,000 volunteers enlist; Pompey Pals formed in Portsmouth.

1914 **First Battle of Ypres: Sepoy Khudadad Khan VC**
Indian Army divisions arrive in France to stabilize the British frontline against overwhelming German assaults.

1915 **Munitions Crisis, DORA & Women in Industry**
Shell shortages prompt state takeover of factories; Lloyd George mobilises women as "Canary Girls"; DORA expands.

1916 **Military Service Act (Conscription) & The Somme**
Compulsory conscription begins; 57,470 British casualties on Day 1 of the Somme; Haig's war of attrition.

1917 **Passchendaele, Tank Warfare & Global Labour**
Mud of Third Ypres; 140,000 Chinese labourers and BWIR handle ammunition; first major tank attack at Cambrai.

1918 **Spring Offensive, Hundred Days & Armistice**
German Kaiserschlacht fails; Allied combined-arms Hundred Days Offensive breaks Hindenburg Line; Armistice signed.

1919 **Paris Peace Conference & Treaty of Versailles**
The Big Three draft the peace; Article 231 war guilt and £6.6bn reparations imposed; League of Nations founded.

1922 **Communal Memorialisation: Stubbington Green**
Thatched memorial shelter built over village pump on Stubbington Green, honoring 67 fallen local heroes.

Hampshire & Meon Valley Local History Connection:

The Great War is engraved into our local Hampshire landscape: from the Portsmouth Dockyard workers who formed the 14th and 15th (Portsmouth) Battalions—the famous **Pompey Pals** who suffered catastrophic losses on the Somme—to the **Stubbington Village War Memorial** on the green commemorating 67 fallen men, including blacksmith Arthur Tribbeck's sons and the Lowry brothers of Manor Way Grange.

Turn overleaf to begin Lesson 1 (Pages 4–5 Facing Spread) →

L1: Why did so many young British men volunteer to join the armed forces in 1914?

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Explain the historical context, key protagonists, and competing perspectives of this enquiry.
- Deploy precise factual evidence to analyse cause, consequence, or military significance.
- Formulate an independent, evaluative historical judgement supported by causal reasoning.

DO NOW: SPACED RETRIEVAL

Score: / 5

Q1 (Last)

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Q2 (Last)

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Q3 (2 Ago)

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Q4 (Unit)

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Q5 (Synoptic)

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CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Distinguish between Britain's small professional army of 120,000 regulars in August 1914 (**BEF**) and Kitchener's civilian volunteer units raised from towns and workmates (**Pals Battalions**):

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TASK 4: THE ENLISTMENT BALANCE SHEET: PUSH FACTORS VS PULL FACTORS (1914)

ANALYTICAL BALANCE SHEET & MOTIVATION AUDIT

Balance the negative domestic pressures driving men into uniform against the positive incentives attracting them to join up:

Push Factors (Domestic Pressure & Fear)

- The Order of the White Feather: public shaming on buses and parks.
- Emotional guilt from posters: "Women of Britain Say GO!".
- Fear of being branded a coward or slacker by neighbours.
- Grinding poverty, low industrial wages, and bleak factory work.

👉 Synthesise their perspective in 2–3 sentences:

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Pull Factors (Patriotism & Opportunity)

- Lord Kitchener's personal call: "Your Country Needs YOU".
- Defending "Brave Little Belgium" against brutal German aggression.
- Comradeship of Pals Battalions: serve alongside mates and brothers.
- Excitement, foreign adventure, regular food, and warm uniforms.

👉 Synthesise their perspective in 2–3 sentences:

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Low-Floor Clue: In Hampshire, over 1,000 men from Portsmouth Dockyard joined the Pompey Pals in just two weeks so they would not be separated from their workmates.

★ **Scholar's Edge:** How does the tragic wipeout of Pals Battalions on 1 July 1916 challenge the idea that voluntary local recruitment was a humane military policy?

Enquiry: Why did so many young British men volunteer to join the armed forces in 1914?

INDEPENDENT ARGUMENT

1. PATRIOTIC MOMENTUM & ADVENTURE

Explain how Kitchener's appeal, German atrocities in Belgium, escaping factory monotony, and the belief in a quick victory by Christmas drove the initial surge of 500,000 recruits.

2. SOCIAL COERCION & THE PALS

Explain how the White Feather campaign, women's emotional pressure ("Women of Britain Say GO!"), and the peer camaraderie of Pals Battalions (Pompey Pals) made staying home socially humiliating.

3. WEIGHING THE DECISIVE CATALYST

Give your final judgment: was voluntary enlistment driven primarily by positive patriotic idealism, or by the crushing weight of domestic shame and moral guilt?

Sentence Starters & Connectives: A primary catalyst for the rush to enlist was... • In addition, men were profoundly influenced by... • Conversely, intense social pressure was exerted through... • Weighing the balance... • Ultimately, I conclude that voluntary enlistment was primarily driven by...

[P] Point: Clear direct answer to enquiry.

[E] Evidence: Specific wartime names, dates & statistics.

[E] Explanation: Causal mechanism (why & how).

[L] Link: Direct evaluative conclusion.

Handwriting practice lines consisting of 15 horizontal blue lines.

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5] | Subject Knowledge: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] | Disciplinary Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4]

PEEL Mastery: P E E L

L2: Did British generals make the horror of trench warfare worse?

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Explain the historical context, key protagonists, and competing perspectives of this enquiry.
- Deploy precise factual evidence to analyse cause, consequence, or military significance.
- Formulate an independent, evaluative historical judgement supported by causal reasoning.

DO NOW: SPACED RETRIEVAL

Score: / 5

Q1 (Last)

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Q2 (Last)

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Q3 (2 Ago)

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Q4 (Unit)

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Q5 (Synoptic)

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CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Write one analytical sentence connecting Haig's strategic doctrine of a **War of Attrition** to the tactical evolution of the artillery **Creeping Barrage**:

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TASK 4: ANATOMY OF THE WESTERN FRONT: THE THREE-LINE TRENCH NETWORK

DEFENSIVE ARCHITECTURE & TACTICAL ANATOMY

Analyse the defensive engineering and lethal vectors of the trench system below:

① **Frontline Trench:** Firebays and traverses (zigzags) designed to contain blast and prevent enfilade fire.

③ **Communication Trenches:** Deep zigzag corridors connecting frontline to support and reserve lines under cover.

② **No Man's Land & Barbed Wire:** 50–500 yards of cratered wasteland sown with impenetrable razor wire belts.

④ **Support & Reserve Lines:** Concrete pillboxes, deep dugout shelters (up to 30ft underground), and machine-gun nests.

Tactical Analysis: In 3–4 sentences, explain why machine guns and barbed wire gave defensive forces an insurmountable advantage over attacking infantry in 1916:

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Low-Floor Clue: A single German Maxim machine gun fired 500 rounds per minute—the equivalent of an entire rifle company firing simultaneously.

★ **Scholar's Edge:** Why did historian John Terraine argue that Haig had no alternative to attrition because there was "no open flank in France"?

Enquiry: Did British generals make the horror of trench warfare worse?

INDEPENDENT ARGUMENT

1. THE CASE FOR THE PROSECUTION

Explain the arguments against Haig: unbending belief in cavalry breakthrough, distance from the mud ("chateau generals"), repeating frontal assaults, and 57,470 casualties on 1 July 1916.

2. THE CASE FOR THE DEFENCE

Explain the defence of Haig: the steep "Industrial Learning Curve", relief of the French at Verdun, lack of radio communications, developing the creeping barrage, and introducing tanks.

3. SUSTAINED HISTORICAL VERDICT

Give your final evaluative judgment: were British generals incompetent "donkeys" squandering brave soldiers, or professionals caught in an unprecedented technological trap?

Sentence Starters & Connectives: Critics of the British military leadership contend that... • Evidence demonstrating command inflexibility includes... • In sharp contrast, revisionist historians argue that... • Crucially, commanders faced... • On balance, my historical judgment is that...

[P] Point: Clear direct answer to enquiry.

[E] Evidence: Specific wartime names, dates & statistics.

[E] Explanation: Causal mechanism (why & how).

[L] Link: Direct evaluative conclusion.

Handwriting practice lines consisting of 15 horizontal blue lines.

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5] | Subject Knowledge: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] | Disciplinary Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4]

PEEL Mastery: P E E L

L3: Why were the military contributions of 4 million colonial soldiers and labourers marginalized in British memory?

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Explain the historical context, key protagonists, and competing perspectives of this enquiry.
- Deploy precise factual evidence to analyse cause, consequence, or military significance.
- Formulate an independent, evaluative historical judgement supported by causal reasoning.

DO NOW: SPACED RETRIEVAL

Score: / 5

Q1 (Last)

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Q2 (Last)

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Q3 (2 Ago)

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Q4 (Unit)

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Q5 (Synoptic)

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CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Distinguish between professional South Asian frontline infantrymen (**sepoys**) and the 140,000 non-combat civilian logistical workers recruited from China (**CLC**):

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TASK 4: IMPERIAL CONTRIBUTION MATRIX: THE GLOBAL WAR MACHINE

IMPERIAL MOBILISATION & DISCIPLINARY AUDIT

Audit the scale of mobilisation, key deployments, and postwar recognition across the Empire:

The Indian Army (1.5 Million Mobilised)

Sepoy Khudadad Khan won the first VC at Hollebeke (1914). Indian divisions held 33% of the British frontline in autumn 1914, suffering over 74,000 dead across France and Mesopotamia.

British West Indies Regiment (16,000 Men)

Caribbean volunteers served under relentless artillery fire carrying heavy shells and building supply roads. Barred from combat in France; rebelled against racism at Taranto in 1918.

Chinese Labour Corps (140,000 Men)

Maintained railroads, unloaded munitions ships, and cleared unexploded ordnance. Over 20,000 died from Spanish Flu and shelling; buried in northern France with no public British monument.

African Troops & Carriers (Over 1 Million)

Carrier Corps sustained the East Africa campaign under horrific conditions. Over 100,000 African porters died of exhaustion, disease, and starvation with zero individual gravestones.

Synoptic Synthesis: Synthesise why David Olusoga terms the Western Front an "Empire battlefield", and explain why postwar memorials focused almost exclusively on white British soldiers:

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Low-Floor Clue: Notice that without Indian troops in autumn 1914, the German army would likely have broken through to the Channel ports.

★ **Scholar's Edge:** How did the Imperial War Graves Commission's 1923 policy systematically treat white soldiers to individual headstones while African dead received mass unmarked cairns?

Enquiry: Why were the military contributions of 4 million colonial soldiers and labourers marginalized in British memory?

INDEPENDENT ARGUMENT

1. VITAL IMPERIAL MOBILISATION

Explain how 1.5 million Indian troops stabilized the frontline at Ypres and Neuve Chapelle in 1914, while the BWIR handled artillery shells and 140,000 Chinese labourers maintained supply lines.

2. RACIAL DISCRIMINATION & CENSORSHIP

Explain the racial hierarchy: restricting non-white troops from combat in Europe, censoring sepoy letters, isolating wounded Indians behind gates at Brighton, and denying equal officer ranks.

3. HISTORIOGRAPHICAL EVALUATION

Formulate your sustained thesis: why did postwar British commemoration erase non-white troops to create a white national myth of the "British Tommy", and why must this narrative be rewritten?

Sentence Starters & Connectives: The decisive contribution of the British Empire is demonstrated by... • Furthermore, without the Indian Corps in 1914... • In direct contrast to this sacrifice, colonial troops experienced... • Consequently, postwar commemoration... • In conclusion, this marginalisation occurred because...

[P] Point: Clear direct answer to enquiry.

[E] Evidence: Specific wartime names, dates & statistics.

[E] Explanation: Causal mechanism (why & how).

[L] Link: Direct evaluative conclusion.

Handwriting practice lines consisting of 15 horizontal blue lines.

L4: How far did the First World War transform the role of the British state and daily life on the Home Front?

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Explain the historical context, key protagonists, and competing perspectives of this enquiry.
- Deploy precise factual evidence to analyse cause, consequence, or military significance.
- Formulate an independent, evaluative historical judgement supported by causal reasoning.

DO NOW: SPACED RETRIEVAL

Score: / 5

Q1 (Last)

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Q2 (Last)

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Q3 (2 Ago)

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Q4 (Unit)

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Q5 (Synoptic)

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CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Write one analytical sentence connecting the sweeping government powers granted under **DORA** to the industrial mobilisation of female **Munitionettes**:

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TASK 4: THE TOTAL WAR LEDGER: STATE EXPANSION VS FEMALE EMANCIPATION

TOTAL WAR BALANCE SHEET & SOCIAL AUDIT

Balance the repressive growth of state intervention against the progressive opportunities gained by women on the Home Front:

State Coercion & Civil Control

- DORA: arrest without warrant, press censorship, and curfews.
- Conscription (1916): forced military service for all men aged 18–41.
- Brutal persecution of Conscientious Objectors (Richmond Sixteen).
- Compulsory food rationing (1918) for butter, sugar, and meat.

👉 Synthesise their perspective in 2–3 sentences:

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Women's Mobilisation & Freedom

- Over 1 million women in heavy industry, transport, and police work.
- Financial independence: munitionettes earned up to £5 a week.
- Heroic physical sacrifice: TNT poisoning and chemical explosions.
- Political enfranchisement: 1918 Representation of the People Act.

👉 Synthesise their perspective in 2–3 sentences:

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Low-Floor Clue: Before 1914, most working-class women were confined to domestic service as maids or laundry workers.

★ **Scholar's Edge:** *Did the 1918 Act grant women the vote because of their war work, or because politicians feared a pre-war Suffragette resurgence if they were excluded?*

Enquiry: How far did the First World War transform the role of the British state and daily life on the Home Front?

INDEPENDENT ARGUMENT

1. EXPANSION OF STATE POWER

Explain how DORA (1914) suspended civil liberties, censored the press, controlled alcohol, and introduced compulsory military conscription (1916) and food rationing (1918).

2. WOMEN'S INDUSTRIAL MOBILISATION

Explain the breakthrough of 1 million female munitions workers ("Canary Girls"), toxic TNT exposure, financial independence, and the passage of the 1918 Representation of the People Act.

3. SUSTAINED HISTORICAL JUDGEMENT

Evaluate whether the war caused a permanent revolution in British society, or whether the return to peacetime in 1919 forced women back into traditional domestic roles.

Sentence Starters & Connectives: The outbreak of total war immediately altered daily life through... • In particular, state control reached unprecedented levels under DORA, which... • Concurrently, women experienced profound social transformation when... • However, this emancipation was qualified by... • In summary, the war transformed Britain by...

[P] Point: Clear direct answer to enquiry.

[E] Evidence: Specific wartime names, dates & statistics.

[E] Explanation: Causal mechanism (why & how).

[L] Link: Direct evaluative conclusion.

Extended writing area with horizontal lines for student response.

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5] | Subject Knowledge: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] | Disciplinary Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4]

PEEL Mastery: P E E L

L5: Was the Treaty of Versailles a justified peace or a fatally flawed compromise?

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Explain the historical context, key protagonists, and competing perspectives of this enquiry.
- Deploy precise factual evidence to analyse cause, consequence, or military significance.
- Formulate an independent, evaluative historical judgement supported by causal reasoning.

DO NOW: SPACED RETRIEVAL

Score: / 5

Q1 (Last)

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Q2 (Last)

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Q3 (2 Ago)

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Q4 (Unit)

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Q5 (Synoptic)

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CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Distinguish between the moral clause placing sole blame on Germany (**Article 231**) and the financial compensation demanded by the Allies (**Reparations**):

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TASK 4: THE VERSAILLES COMPROMISE LEDGER: SECURITY VS REVENGE VS STABILITY

DIPLOMATIC CRUCIBLE & TREATY AUDIT

Audit the irreconcilable war aims of the Big Three leaders at the Paris Peace Conference:

Clemenceau's French Demands (Security & Revenge)

- Demanded permanent destruction of German military might.
- Annexation of Alsace-Lorraine and occupation of the Rhineland.
- Maximum reparations to pay for French reconstruction.
- Slogan: "Germany Must Pay!" — driven by fear of future invasion.

👉 Synthesise their perspective in 2–3 sentences:

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Wilson & Lloyd George (Stability & Trade)

- Wilson's 14 Points: national self-determination and League of Nations.
- Lloyd George wanted Germany as a strong British trading partner.
- Feared that an impoverished Germany would fall to Bolshevism (Communism).
- Warned that humiliating Germany would provoke future revenge.

👉 Synthesise their perspective in 2–3 sentences:

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Low-Floor Clue: The cartoonist Will Dyson drew Clemenceau leaving Versailles saying: "Curious! I seem to hear a child weeping!" — the child was labelled "1940 Class".

★ **Scholar's Edge:** Why did historian Margaret MacMillan argue that Versailles did not cause WWII, but rather the Allied failure to enforce its disarmament clauses in the 1930s?

Enquiry: Was the Treaty of Versailles a justified peace or a fatally flawed compromise?

INDEPENDENT ARGUMENT

1. THE JUSTIFICATION FOR HARSH TERMS

Explain Allied grievances: French devastation (1.4 million dead, industrial north ruined), Belgian occupation, the brutal German Treaty of Brest-Litovsk, and Article 231 (War Guilt).

2. THE FLAWS & GERMAN GRIEVANCE

Explain why Germans viewed the treaty as a "Diktat": loss of 13% territory and 6 million citizens, £6.6 billion reparations, 100,000-man army limit, and Will Dyson's "1940 Class" warning.

3. SUSTAINED HISTORICAL VERDICT

Formulate your judgment: was Versailles an unjust "Carthaginian peace" that made World War II inevitable, or a reasonable compromise that failed only because the Allies refused to enforce it?

Sentence Starters & Connectives: Allied statesmen justified severe terms on the grounds that... • Most controversially, Article 231 forced Germany to... • Conversely, critics like Keynes argued that... • The fatal flaw of the settlement was... • Ultimately, I conclude that Versailles was...

[P] Point: Clear direct answer to enquiry.

[E] Evidence: Specific wartime names, dates & statistics.

[E] Explanation: Causal mechanism (why & how).

[L] Link: Direct evaluative conclusion.

Handwriting practice lines consisting of 15 horizontal blue lines.

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5] | Subject Knowledge: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] | Disciplinary Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4]

PEEL Mastery: P E E L

L6: How did the human cost of the Great War shatter and reshape our local Hampshire community of Stubbington?

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Explain the historical context, key protagonists, and competing perspectives of this enquiry.
- Deploy precise factual evidence to analyse cause, consequence, or military significance.
- Formulate an independent, evaluative historical judgement supported by causal reasoning.

DO NOW: SPACED RETRIEVAL

Score: / 5

Q1 (Last)

Q2 (Last)

Q3 (2 Ago)

Q4 (Unit)

Q5 (Synoptic)

CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Write one analytical sentence connecting the demographic catastrophe of the **Lost Generation** to the communal **Memorialisation** on Stubbington Green:

TASK 4: FORENSIC DISSECTION OF THE STUBBINGTON WAR MEMORIAL SHELTER (1922)

LOCAL ARCHIVAL FORENSIC DISSECTION: STUBBINGTON GREEN

Examine the archival evidence from our village green and parish records below:

① **The 67 Names on the Beams:** Hand-carved into English oak timbers under a unique thatched roof built over the village water pump.

③ **Arthur Tribbeck (Blacksmith):** Lost two sons to the conflict, including Stoker Arthur Tribbeck drowned when HMS Narbrough was wrecked in a blizzard.

② **The Lowry Brothers (Manor Way Grange):** Major Auriol Lowry DSO MC survived with severe wounds; his brother Lt Cyril Lowry was killed leading his platoon in 1917.

④ **The "Dead Man's Penny":** Heavy bronze memorial plaques inscribed "He died for freedom and honour" delivered to 67 bereaved Stubbington homes.

Communal Analysis: In 3–4 sentences, explain why the parish of Stubbington chose to build a practical thatched shelter over the water pump rather than a cold stone obelisk:

Low-Floor Clue: The thatched shelter provided daily protection from the rain for villagers waiting for transport or gathering water, keeping the memory of the fallen intertwined with daily life.

★ **Scholar's Edge:** How does the Lowry family's donation of the Holy Rood memorial lychgate demonstrate how the landed gentry used religious architecture to cope with the extinction of their family line?

2. BEREAVEMENT ACROSS SOCIAL DIVISIONS

3. ARCHITECTURE OF REMEMBRANCE & LEGACY

Sentence Starters & Connectives: The human cost of the war was felt with exceptional intimacy in Stubbington because... • Families across all social divisions suffered catastrophic loss, as shown by... • The physical architecture of remembrance on the village green proves that... • Consequently, the concept of a "lost generation"... • Overall, the local legacy was...

[L] Link: Direct evaluative conclusion.

L7: “The First World War was a total war that completely transformed the modern world.” How far do you agree? (1914–1919)

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Explain the historical context, key protagonists, and competing perspectives of this enquiry.
- Deploy precise factual evidence to analyse cause, consequence, or military significance.
- Formulate an independent, evaluative historical judgement supported by causal reasoning.

DO NOW: SPACED RETRIEVAL

Score: / 5

Q1 (Last)

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Q2 (Last)

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Q3 (2 Ago)

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Q4 (Unit)

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Q5 (Synoptic)

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CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Distinguish between 19th-century battles fought strictly between professional armies (**limited warfare**) and 20th-century conflicts mobilising entire civilian economies and populations (**total war**):

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TASK 4: SYNOPTIC MASTER MATRIX: THE FOUR TURNING POINTS (1914–1919)

SYNOPTIC CRUCIBLE & MASTER SYNTHESIS

Synthesise the four decisive vectors that reshaped global history between 1914 and 1919:

1. Industrialized Military Attrition

Trench warfare, machine guns, heavy artillery, creeping barrages, and tanks transformed combat from heroic cavalry charges into mechanized industrial slaughter claiming 20 million lives.

2. The Imperial & Global Dimension

Over 4 million soldiers and labourers from India, Africa, China, and the Caribbean mobilized to sustain the Allied front, sparking postwar anti-colonial resistance and demands for self-rule.

3. Total War on the Home Front

DORA established unprecedented state control over food, pubs, and press. 1 million women entered munitions factories, breaking Victorian gender roles and winning the vote in 1918.

4. The Flawed Versailles Settlement

The collapse of 4 historic empires left Central Europe fractured. The punitive terms of Article 231 and reparations bred intense German resentment, directly incubating World War II.

Synoptic Synthesis: Synthesise your overarching judgment: was the Great War primarily a catalyst for democratic modernization, or a senseless industrial tragedy that broke European civilization?

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Low-Floor Clue: Notice how every modern institution—from passports and daylight saving time to women's voting rights and blood transfusions—was shaped by the Great War.

★ **Scholar's Edge:** How does historian David Stevenson's verdict that "the war solved none of the problems of 1914 while creating the catastrophes of 1939" balance against the social emancipation of working-class citizens?

Enquiry: “The First World War was a total war that completely transformed the modern world.” How far do you agree? (1914–1919)

INDEPENDENT ARGUMENT

1. MILITARY & GEOPOLITICAL REVOLUTION

Explain how the war destroyed 4 historic empires (German, Russian, Austro-Hungarian, Ottoman), created modern industrialised warfare (tanks, planes, poison gas), and made the USA a global superpower.

2. SOCIAL & IMPERIAL TRANSFORMATION

Explain the transformation of civil society: DORA, women’s industrial mobilisation and the 1918 vote, the mobilization of 4 million colonial troops, and the collapse of Victorian class deference.

3. SYNOPTIC HISTORICAL JUDGEMENT

Formulate your sustained thesis: did the war genuinely build a progressive new world, or did it primarily bequeath trauma, economic exhaustion, and the seeds of another catastrophic conflict in 1939?

Sentence Starters & Connectives: In assessing the transformative scale of the Great War... • Militarily and geopolitically, the conflict revolutionized the world through... • Concurrently, social and imperial structures were reshaped by... • However, this transformation was fundamentally compromised by... • In conclusion, I judge that...

[P] Point: Clear direct answer to enquiry.

[E] Evidence: Specific wartime names, dates & statistics.

[E] Explanation: Causal mechanism (why & how).

[L] Link: Direct evaluative conclusion.

Handwriting practice area with 20 horizontal lines.

VOCABULARY MASTERY VAULT • THE GREAT WAR

KS3 Disciplinary & Substantive Concepts • Year 9 History

MASTERY

Mastery of these high-yield disciplinary and substantive concepts is essential for achieving Grade 6–9 in KS3 History extended writing:

Total War:

A conflict demanding complete mobilization of an entire society's civilian workforce, industry, agriculture, and military resources, eliminating the distinction between combatant and civilian.

Pals Battalions (1914):

Volunteer military units recruited under Lord Kitchener allowing workmates, football teams, and neighbours to serve together; suffered catastrophic concentrated local losses on the Somme.

War of Attrition:

A military strategy aiming to wear down the enemy's manpower, reserves, and industrial supplies through sustained slaughter until total physical collapse.

Defence of the Realm Act (DORA):

Emergency British legislation passed in August 1914 granting the government sweeping autocratic powers to censor the press, requisition property, and control daily civilian habits.

Conscription & Conscientious Objection:

Compulsory military call-up introduced in 1916; opposed by conscientious objectors on moral or religious grounds, who faced harsh military tribunals and imprisonment.

Canary Girls (Munitionettes):

Over 1 million women who machined artillery shells in national projectile factories; nicknamed for their yellowing skin caused by toxic TNT jaundice.

Article 231 (The War Guilt Clause):

The controversial clause in the 1919 Treaty of Versailles forcing Germany to accept sole moral and legal responsibility for causing all Allied damage, justifying £6.6bn reparations.

Lost Generation & Memorialisation:

The generation of young men decimated by industrialized combat; commemorated through stone monuments, war memorial shelters, and annual remembrance rituals across Britain.

END OF UNIT REFLECTION & PUPIL VOICE

PUPIL VOICE

Unit: The Great War (1914–1919) • Year 9 History

1. WHAT WENT WELL (WWW)

Key Strengths & Insights

Which Great War enquiry, primary source (e.g. Wilfred Owen, sepoy letters, Stubbington names), or extended writing skill did you find most compelling or master most successfully?

2. EVEN BETTER IF (EBI)

Areas for Growth

Which historical concept (e.g. military attrition, evaluating conflicting historical interpretations of Haig, or the economic impact of Versailles) did you find most challenging?

TEACHER FORMATIVE COACHING & NEXT STEPS

Completed post-assessment

Teacher feedback confirming unit mastery, validating reflection, and setting next unit targets:

DEPARTMENTAL MARKING POLICY & CODE

POLICY

Meoncross School History Department Standard

FORMATIVE CORRECTION CODES:

Code	Meaning & Focus	Pupil Action / Dirt Task
Sp	Spelling error in key historical term.	Copy the correct spelling 3 times in margin.
Gr / P	Grammar or punctuation slip.	Rewrite the sentence correctly in green pen.
//	New paragraph required here.	Insert // symbol and start a new line.
[?]	Meaning unclear / vague phrasing.	Clarify argument using specific evidence.
Ev	Missing precise factual evidence.	Add specific dates, names, or statistics.
Ex	Explanation needs deeper causal link.	Use 'This meant that...' or 'Consequently...'.
J	Historical judgment needed.	Weigh both factors to reach a sustained verdict.

THE 4 GOLDEN RULES OF HISTORICAL EXTENDED WRITING:

1. **Direct Answer:** Open every paragraph with a clear thematic point that directly addresses the enquiry question.
2. **Specific Evidence:** Ground every argument in precise historical facts, figures, names, and contemporary legislation.
3. **Causal Connectives:** Never just describe events; explain the mechanism of how and why one event caused or accelerated another.
4. **Evaluative Judgement:** Weigh competing arguments against explicit historical criteria to reach a nuanced, independent conclusion.

MEONCROSS SCHOOL • DEPARTMENT OF HISTORY

Stubbington, Fareham, Hampshire • Academic Year 2025–2026